

PRIVATE · VERSION 2.0 · JULY 2026

Family Money HQ

A Family Operating System

The app does not optimize money. It optimizes our family's future.
Money is the operating system that funds it.

“It doesn't just answer: where did our money go?
It answers: are we building the life we said we wanted?”

v2.0 — revised after Shlomo's review of v1.0.

Legacy is now the destination. Every dollar gets a name on it.
We perfect this document first — then we build exactly what it says.

SECTION 1

Vision — the six-step progression

One private app where Shlomo and Rachel sign in and run the family — every account, every child, every goal, every document — with a system that makes the right thing automatic and the wrong thing hard. The end state is not a number. It is a family whose future is funded and whose values transfer with the assets.

Step	Stage	What it means
1	Control spending	Guardrails, the alert ladder, self-binding rules — Section 5.
2	Automate saving	The income waterfall: every dollar assigned the day it arrives — Section 6.
3	Build wealth	Boring automatic investing plus the disciplined real-estate desk — Section 9.
4	Protect wealth	Insurance, estate documents, the Legacy Vault, kill switches — Sections 10-11.
5	Fund the children's future	A full financial life per child, tracked to 100% funded — Section 4.
6	Transfer values, not just assets	The Family Constitution, annual letters, the Summit — Section 10.

Each step rests on the one before it. The app always shows where we are on this ladder — and the ladder, not the account balance, is the real scoreboard.

SECTION 2

The family — who signs in, and what they see

Person	Role	What they see & do
Shlomo	Owner	Everything. Sets rules with Rachel. Receives guardrail alerts about his own spending. Cannot silently raise his own limits — loosening takes effect after a 72-hour delay and a note to Rachel (self-binding by design).
Rachel	Owner	Everything, equal standing. Receives the weekly digest and any tripped guardrail alerts. Approves rule changes early (the two-key rule).
Judah	Profile now, viewer later	A full financial life from day one (Section 4). When old enough: an age-appropriate view of his own goals and a savings match — money education, no account access.
Baby #2 & any future children	Profile	A profile exists before the birth certificate does: adding a child opens the pre-arrival checklist (insurance update, new 529, estate amendment).

Person	Role	What they see & do
Advisor / CPA (later)	Guest	Read-only, time-limited link to the annual report pack. No credentials, no transaction detail unless we share it.

Sign-in: email + password + two-factor (authenticator app or passkey). Every sensitive action (rule change, transfer rule, vault access, export) is logged in an audit trail both owners can read — trust through transparency.

SECTION 3

The nine pillars

Everything the app does falls under one of these. If a feature idea doesn't fit a pillar, it doesn't go in. Pillar 9 is the destination the other eight exist to serve.

1. Connected accounts

Every bank account, credit card, loan, and investment account linked through Plaid (Section 6). Balances and transactions sync several times a day; manual accounts (cash, private loans, the business draw) added by hand. One screen = the whole picture.

2. Missions — every dollar gets a job

The four buckets of v1.0 grow into named Missions: money assigned to a person and a purpose (“Judah — Education”, “Emergency Fund”, “Property #1”). Income flows through the waterfall (Section 6) until nothing floats unassigned.

3. Guardrails — “keep me in check”

The conscience of the app: real-time rules that watch spending and respond on a ladder — nudge › alert › cool-down › witness. Built for a compulsive spender, with dignity. Section 5.

4. Autopilot

Transfers earn trust in stages: guided (we tap), bank-native rules (the app audits), app-initiated (capped + two-key). Section 6.

5. Net worth & goals

The monthly scoreboard: assets minus debts, trend over time, and funding progress on every Mission. The page we open at the monthly money meeting.

6. The real-estate desk

Allocation cap, a deal analyzer that forces day-one cash-flow math, and a pipeline board. Real estate is a lane, not the whole road. Section 9.

7. The Library & curriculum

The books and thinkers as a guided reading plan — now including the behavioral-finance bench (Section 12) — plus a dedicated track on compulsive spending and money psychology.

8. The AI Chief Financial Officer

Claude stops waiting for questions and takes on scheduled jobs: daily pulse, weekly digest, monthly close, quarterly opportunities, annual review. Section 8.

9. Family Legacy

The destination. Every family member with a timeline, goals, accounts, letters, and memories; the Family Constitution; the Annual Summit; the Legacy Vault; the Family Strength Score. Net worth becomes life worth. Sections 4 and 10-11.

SECTION 4

Pillar 9 in detail — Family Legacy

Money is no longer anonymous. Every dollar has someone's name on it, and every person in the family has a financial life the app is quietly building.

The family dashboard

One screen, four panels: **Family** (a card per person — Rachel, Shlomo, Judah, Baby #2, future children), **Timeline** (what's coming, below), **Constitution** (Section 10), and **Vault** (Section 11). Each person's card holds their age and life timeline, goals, accounts, insurance coverage, estate status, education plan, investment accounts, memories, and the annual letter written to them.

A full financial life per child — not one “kids fund”

Each child gets a menu of Missions, opened over time. Every Mission carries a goal amount, current balance, projected value at the target date, funding percentage, years remaining, and one AI recommendation.

Life stage	Missions (per child)
Growing up	Education (529 · school · camp · college · seminary/yeshiva) · birthday fund · travel fund
Launching	First car · wedding · first home · business fund · opportunity fund
Protected	Emergency fund · medical reserve · life insurance · inheritance (via the trust)
Formed	Investment account (they watch it grow) · giving fund (they choose where) — the two Missions that teach, not just fund

Opening a child's profile (illustrative numbers)

Judah — Mission	Funded	AI recommendation
Education	72%	On pace. 529 auto-deposit continues.
First home	41%	Ahead of schedule for his age — no change.
Wedding	18%	Slightly behind the glide path.
Business fund	0%	Not yet opened — decision D11.
All missions	—	"Increase monthly deposits by ~\$110 and Judah reaches every goal by age 25."

The Family Timeline

One timeline for the whole family, decades long. Every known life event is on it, and the app prepares for each one *before* it arrives — the app knows what's coming before we feel it. Rows below are the pattern; real dates get filled in at decision D12.

When	Event	The app opens, months ahead
Next year	Baby #2 arrives	Pre-arrival checklist: hospital costs, life-insurance update, new 529, estate/trust amendment, guardianship review.
Early years	Preschool · camp	Tuition Missions activate; monthly funding suggested from the waterfall.
Age 13	Bar mitzvah	Celebration fund with a per-month glide path — funded years out, never financed.
Age 18+	College / seminary	529 drawdown plan; the AI CFO re-projects every year.
Adulthood	Wedding · first home	The long Missions everyone forgets until they're urgent. Here they're 20 years of small deposits instead.

SECTION 5

The guardrail engine — designed for a compulsive spender

The heart of step 1, and the reason the app exists. Built on how compulsive spending actually works: the urge is short, the regret is long, and willpower at the moment of purchase is the wrong tool. The app adds time, friction, and witness — the three things that beat impulse.

The alert ladder

Level	Trigger (draft examples)	What happens
Nudge	A guilt-free bucket reaches 70% with a week left in the month.	Quiet in-app note. No shame, just information: “\$430 left in fun money — 9 days to go.”
Alert	Single purchase over the agreed threshold (e.g. \$500), or a bucket goes over 100%.	Push notification to Shlomo within minutes of the transaction posting, with a one-line “here’s what this does to the month.”
Cool-down	Three alerts in a week, or spending velocity 2x normal for 3 days running.	The app proposes the 24-hour rule: a want-to-buy list where items must sit 24h (over \$200) or 7 days (over \$1,000) before purchase. Tracks how many listed items we still wanted after the wait — usually few.
Witness	Cool-down ignored, or a single transaction over the two-key threshold (e.g. \$2,500).	Rachel gets notified — automatically, as agreed in advance, so it’s the system telling her, not Shlomo confessing. Big purchases simply require both of us. That’s the two-key rule.

Design principles

- **Self-binding, set in calm moments.** Limits loosen only after a 72-hour delay with Rachel's visibility; tightening is instant. Ulysses tied himself to the mast *before* he heard the sirens.
- **Friction for wants, none for needs.** Fixed costs and groceries flow untouched. Friction concentrates only where impulse lives.
- **No shame mechanics.** The tone is a good sponsor's tone: honest, warm, next-step focused. A blown week gets a reset button and one question: “what triggered it?” Consistency is celebrated over perfection.
- **An urge journal.** One tap logs “I wanted to buy ____ because ____.” Over months this becomes the trigger map.
- **The bigger yes.** Every blocked impulse shows the Mission it feeds instead — “that \$1,800 is a month of Judah's education fund.” Tradeoffs are framed as future gains, never as current losses.
- **Beyond the app — named honestly.** Compulsive spending can be a real behavioral addiction. The app links to Debtors Anonymous and to finding a therapist who works with money behaviors. Software is a tool here, not the treatment.

SECTION 6

Every dollar gets a job — the income waterfall

Income arrives; the app routes it the same day, top to bottom, until nothing floats unassigned. The order is the priority. The dashboard's proudest line is: “Every dollar has been assigned.”

Order	Mission	Rule
1	Fixed expenses	Funded first, capped by R1.
2	Emergency fund	Until 6 months of expenses (R4); then skipped.
3	Retirement	Automatic index investing (R2).
4	Brokerage	The flexible wealth engine.
5	Real estate fund	Feeds the Desk, inside the R5 cap.
6	Kids — education	Each child's 529 and school Missions.
7	Kids — life funds	Wedding, first home, launch Missions.
8	Vacation / simchas	Named, dated, guilt-free when spent.
9	Giving / tzedakah	Planned like a Mission, not an afterthought (R12).
10	Fun money	Protected, not just permitted (R3).
11	Opportunity fund	Whatever is left. Dry powder for the deal, the moment, the mitzvah we didn't see coming.

How money actually moves — trust in three stages

Honest engineering truth: an app can't and shouldn't just reach into bank accounts on day one. We earn automation in stages, each useful on its own:

- **Stage A — Guided.** The app computes the routing the moment income lands and sends one push notification; we tap, the bank app opens, the app verifies it happened via the transaction feed.
- **Stage B — Bank-native rules.** Recurring transfers live inside the banks; the app is the auditor that knows every rule and alerts if one fails or quietly gets cancelled.
- **Stage C — App-initiated.** The app moves money itself via Plaid Transfer / ACH — only between our own accounts, under per-transfer and monthly caps, per rules approved by both of us. Phase 3, only after Stages A-B have run clean for months.

Bank connections (read side): Plaid or equivalent. We log into each bank inside Plaid's own secure window — **our app never sees or stores bank passwords**; it holds only revocable read tokens. Same rails as Venmo and every budgeting app. Roughly \$10-30/month at our scale.

Raises and windfalls: when income jumps, the waterfall automatically proposes saving at least half the raise *before* lifestyle expands (pay-yourself-first; Thaler's Save More Tomorrow). Lifestyle creep needs a signature, not a shrug.

SECTION 7

The Rulebook — the numbers the app enforces

Written once, in calm, enforced by software. Draft values — we finalize them together before build. Every rule is tunable, with the 72-hour loosening delay.

#	Rule	Draft value
R1	Fixed costs ceiling (% of take-home)	60% max
R2	Automatic investing floor (% of take-home, monthly)	15% min
R3	Guilt-free spending — protected, not just capped	20-30%
R4	Emergency reserve target (months of expenses, high-yield savings)	6 months
R5	Real-estate allocation cap (% of net worth incl. home)	40% max
R6	Single-purchase alert threshold	\$500
R7	24-hour rule threshold / 7-day rule threshold	\$200 / \$1,000
R8	Two-key purchases (both must approve)	\$2,500+
R9	Any new debt besides a mortgage	Two-key + 7 days
R10	Weekly money check-in (15 min) / monthly meeting (45 min)	Sun / 1st of month
R11	Rental deals must cash-flow day one (after vacancy, mgmt, upkeep)	DSCR 1.25+
R12	Tzedakah / giving — a waterfall Mission, not an afterthought	set together
R13	Raise rule: % of any raise saved before lifestyle expands	50% min
R14	Kids' Missions funded before parents' luxuries upgrade	always
R15	Every two-key decision is checked against the Constitution	always

The Rulebook lives on its own page in the app, signed by both of us, with a change history. Rules are the product; screens are just how we look at them.

SECTION 8

The AI Chief Financial Officer

Claude doesn't wait to be asked. It holds scheduled jobs with named outputs, grounded in our live numbers, the Rulebook, the Constitution, and the Library's principles. Warm, direct, zero scolding.

Cadence	Job	Sounds like
Daily	The pulse: yesterday vs. plan, anything drifting.	"Yesterday you spent \$87 less than budget."

Cadence	Job	Sounds like
Weekly	The digest for the Sunday check-in (R10): buckets, wins, one question to discuss.	"Your investment rate went up this week."
Monthly	The close: plan vs. actual, net worth move, Mission funding, one recommendation.	"You are on track to retire at 53."
Quarterly	Opportunities: allocation drift, cash building up, rate changes, the Desk.	"You'll have enough cash for another rental in ~19 months."
Annually	The Summit report (Section 10) and every child's re-projection.	"Judah's education fund is 8% behind — add \$95/month to close it."

The CFO also runs the Family Timeline: it opens checklists for upcoming life events months ahead, re-projects every Mission when reality drifts from plan, and drafts — never sends — anything that involves the outside world.

SECTION 9

The real-estate desk

Real estate is a lane, not the whole road. The desk keeps it disciplined.

- **Allocation gauge.** Live view of real estate as % of net worth against the R5 cap, on every deal screen.
- **Deal analyzer.** Enter address, price, expected rent > the app forces the boring math: vacancy 8%, management 8-10%, maintenance/capex 10-15%, taxes, insurance, a real mortgage quote. Outputs cash-on-cash, cap rate, DSCR, and a plain verdict. *No deal can be marked "buy" if it fails R11.*
- **Pipeline board.** Watching > Analyzed > Offer > Owned. Every property we even glance at gets a card, so urgency-sellers get answered with data.
- **Owned-property P&L.** Each property's true annual return — compared honestly against "what if this equity were in index funds."
- **The funding path.** The waterfall's real-estate Mission shows time-to-down-payment at current pace.

SECTION 10

The Family Constitution & the Annual Summit

Step 6 of the ladder: transferring values, not just assets.

The Constitution — one page, signed by both of us

Written together, revised only at a Summit. It answers six questions:

Question	Why it matters
What do we believe about money?	The values sentence everything else hangs from.
What do we spend freely on?	Our money dials — lavish here, guilt-free, on purpose.
What do we never finance?	The bright lines that end debates before they start.
How much risk do we take?	Sets the caps in the Rulebook (R5, R9, R11).
What does “rich” mean to us?	The definition of enough — the whole game (House).
What are we trying to build?	The sentence Judah reads someday and recognizes.

Every two-key decision screen shows the Constitution next to the numbers (R15). The question is never only “can we afford it?” — it’s “is this us?”

The Annual Family Summit

Once a year, a real sit-down. The app auto-generates the report pack — our family’s Berkshire letter: net worth and returns, spending, taxes, giving, each child’s Missions and projections, estate and insurance status, real estate, goals hit and missed, lessons learned, wins, mistakes, and next year’s goals. We add the human part: the annual letter to each child, and this year’s family video. The Summit closes with signatures: Constitution reaffirmed or amended, Rulebook re-signed, next year’s numbers set.

SECTION 11

The Legacy Vault & the Family Strength Score

The Legacy Vault

Encrypted storage for the documents and words that matter: wills, trusts, insurance policies, birth certificates, passports, property deeds, account inventory, passwords (via a proper password manager, referenced not copied), letters to the kids, annual videos, voice recordings. Organized so that if something happened tomorrow, Rachel — or the trustee — would know exactly where everything is. A sealed “break-glass” page prints the first-72-hours instructions; opening it is logged and alerts the other owner.

The Family Strength Score

Not a credit score — a weighted health check across ten categories. The goal is not to maximize the score; it is to surface the weakest area before it becomes a problem. The AI CFO reports the weakest category every month, with one concrete move to strengthen it.

Category	Weight	Category	Weight
Emergency preparedness	15%	Insurance coverage	10%
Savings rate	12%	Debt management	10%
Investment consistency	12%	Kids' funding progress	12%
Estate planning	12%	Giving	5%
Spending discipline	7%	Long-term goal completion	5%

Weights are drafts (decision D13). Estate, insurance, and kids' funding deliberately outweigh spending: a perfectly-kept budget with no will is a weak family balance sheet.

SECTION 12

The behavioral bench & the Library

The app quietly encodes the best of behavioral finance. These are the defaults under the hood; the Library teaches us why they work.

- **Default to automation** — willpower is not a plan (Thaler & Sunstein, *Nudge*; BJ Fogg on making the right behavior the easy one).
- **Save the raise before the lifestyle sees it** (Thaler's Save More Tomorrow; Rulebook R13).
- **Friction only for impulse** — needs flow, wants wait (Kahneman: give System 2 time to show up).
- **Frame tradeoffs as future gains, not current losses** — every blocked purchase shows the Mission it feeds (loss aversion, flipped).
- **Celebrate consistency, not perfection** — habits compound like money (James Clear, *Atomic Habits*); a blown week gets a reset, not a streak-shaped funeral.
- **Identity over outcomes** — the app talks about who we're becoming ("a family that funds its future"), not just what we saved.

The reading bench

Housel (*The Psychology of Money*) · Sethi (*I Will Teach You to Be Rich*) · Collins (*The Simple Path to Wealth*) · Bogle · Perkins (*Die With Zero*) · Clason · Keller · Munger — joined by the behavioral bench: Clear (*Atomic Habits*), Thaler (*Nudge*, *Misbehaving*), Kahneman (*Thinking, Fast and Slow*), Fogg (*Tiny Habits*), Hallam (*Millionaire Teacher*), and Nick True's mapped-out cash-flow method. One book a month, together; notes live in the Library.

SECTION 13

Architecture, security & running cost

Deliberately boring technology, matched to what already runs Armada — one person can maintain it. Fully separate from the business.

Layer	Choice	Why
Frontend	Server-rendered pages + light JS, installable as a phone app (PWA) for push notifications.	Fast to build, works on both phones.
Backend	Node.js + Express	Same stack as Armada — shared patterns.
Database	PostgreSQL, encrypted at rest; nightly encrypted backups with a tested restore.	Accounts, transactions, Missions, rules, audit log.
Vault	Client-side encryption for vault files; keys held by us, not the server.	The most personal data gets the strongest lock.
Bank data	Plaid (Transactions + Auth; Transfer in Phase 3).	No credentials ever touch our server.
AI	Claude API — claude-sonnet-5 as the CFO; Haiku for the transaction stream.	Scheduled jobs + coaching grounded in our data.
Notifications	Web push + SMS fallback (Twilio) for Witness-level alerts; quiet hours honored (no pings on Shabbos).	Guardrails only work if they reach the phone in minutes.
Hosting	Render — separate account from the business. No employee ever has access.	Personal data stays fully out of company systems.

Security non-negotiables: two-factor for both owners (passkeys preferred) · full audit log readable by both, deletable by neither · a kill switch on either phone that revokes all Plaid tokens and freezes transfers instantly · full data export (CSV/JSON) any time — the app never holds our life hostage.

Running cost: hosting + database ~\$25-40/mo · Plaid ~\$10-30/mo · Claude API ~\$10-25/mo with the CFO jobs · Twilio ~\$5/mo. **Total ~\$50-100/month** — cheaper than one impulse purchase it prevents.

SECTION 14

What this app will not do

Written down so the blueprint stays honest.

- It will not **replace the professionals**: the estate attorney does the trust; a fee-only fiduciary reviews the big picture annually; a therapist or DA meeting addresses compulsion at the root. The app tracks that these happen — it doesn't pretend to be them.
- It will not **move money it wasn't told to move**, ever. App-initiated transfers arrive only in Phase 3, capped and two-key approved.

- It will not **pick investments or time markets**. The investing rule is a boring automatic index-fund transfer; the app's job is to make sure it fires.
- It will not **police Rachel** or become surveillance in either direction. Alerts are symmetric and every monitoring feature is one both partners agreed to in writing (this document).
- It will not **turn the kids into spreadsheets**. Judah sees goals, growth, and a savings match — never guilt, never comparison. The Missions fund a childhood; they don't gamify it.

SECTION 15

Build phases — Legacy is the destination

Each phase is a complete, useful product, used for real before the next one starts. The app earns its next power by being right with the current one.

Phase	What ships	We know it works when...
1 — The Cockpit (~2-3 wks)	Logins + 2FA · manual accounts & CSV import · Missions and plan vs. actual · net worth & goals · family profiles (Judah, Baby #2) · Rulebook & Constitution pages · Library · weekly digest email.	We run one full monthly money meeting inside the app, and the Constitution is signed.
2 — Live Data (~3-4 wks)	Plaid linking · auto-categorization · the guardrail ladder with push alerts · urge journal & want-to-buy list · income detection with guided waterfall (Stage A).	An over-threshold purchase pings Shlomo's phone within minutes; a month of transactions needs under 15 minutes of fixing.
3 — Autopilot (~3-4 wks)	Bank-rule auditor (Stage B) > app-initiated transfers (Stage C, capped, two-key) · AI CFO daily/weekly/monthly jobs · cool-down & witness automation · raise rule.	Three consecutive months of zero-touch saving with zero missed rules, and “every dollar assigned” shows green.
4 — The Desk (~2-3 wks)	Deal analyzer, pipeline, owned-property P&L · quarterly CFO opportunities job · advisor/CPA guest reports.	First property analyzed — or rightly rejected — inside the app.
5 — The Legacy (~3-4 wks)	Full per-child Missions with projections & glide paths · Family Timeline with event checklists · Legacy Vault · Family Strength Score · the Summit report pack · annual letters & videos · kids' view.	We hold the first Annual Family Summit entirely from the app's report — and if something happened tomorrow, Rachel would know exactly where everything is.

SECTION 16

Decisions to make before we build

The blueprint is finished when every line below has an answer. This is the agenda for one sit-down between Shlomo and Rachel.

#	Decision	Notes
D1	Final Rulebook numbers (R1-R15)	Section 7 has drafts
D2	The list of accounts & cards to connect	banks, cards, loans, brokerage
D3	Alert thresholds & quiet hours	no pings on Shabbos — define the window
D4	Witness-level wording	exactly what Rachel's alert says — dignity matters
D5	Money dials	the 1-2 categories we spend lavishly on, guilt-free
D6	Waterfall order & amounts, and starting stage (A/B/C)	Section 6
D7	Estate checklist owner & deadline	who books the attorney, by when
D8	Outside support	therapist / DA meeting cadence — named, scheduled
D9	App name & domain	Family Money HQ is a placeholder
D10	Draft the Constitution's six answers	Section 10 — the one-page version
D11	Each child's Mission menu & priorities	which funds open now vs. later
D12	Real dates for the Family Timeline	birthdays, school years, Baby #2
D13	Strength Score weights	Section 11 has drafts
D14	Vault contents & break-glass person	who besides us can ever open it
D15	Summit date	same week every year — pick the anchor

Next step: read v2.0 together. If the six-step ladder, the waterfall order, and the per-child Missions feel right, answer the D-list and the blueprint is final. Then Phase 1 starts.

Family Money HQ · Blueprint v2.0 · Prepared July 2026 · Education and planning document — not legal, tax, or investment advice.